BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #67 · HEALING AND FAITH

“God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away.”

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Where it often comes from

After praying for months or years for relief, silence can feel like rejection. Some conclude that God is not listening or does not care.

What Scripture teaches

Paul prayed three times and received a “no” with a better promise: “My grace is sufficient for you.” “The Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words.” Jesus prayed in Gethsemane, “Yet not My will, but Yours be done” (Luke 22:42). “He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted… but has attended to his cry for help.” God hears every prayer. His answers are sometimes “wait,” “no,” or “here is strength instead.”

> *“For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help”* (Psalm 22:24).

Also see

> “In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words” (Romans 8:26).

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “‘For My thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways My ways,’ declares the LORD. ‘For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so My ways are higher than your ways and My thoughts than your thoughts.’” (Isaiah 55:8–9).

> “The righteous cry out, and the LORD hears; He delivers them from all their troubles” (Psalm 34:17).

Common self-statements

- God ignores me.
- My prayers bounce off the ceiling.
- He answers others, not me.
- He could heal me if He wanted.
- Prayer is pointless.
- God does not care.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing God either answers my way or does not hear.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no answer ever.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unheard and concluding that He is not listening.
- Labeling: Calling my prayers useless.

Challenging questions

- What have I prayed for, and how long?
- What has God provided that I did not ask for?

- What do Paul and Jesus teach about unanswered prayer?
- How does the Spirit help me pray?
- What would trust look like if the answer is “not now” or “no”?
- Who can pray with me?

Truth summary

> God hears every prayer, even when He does not give the answer I ask for. He may give grace, strength, or a different path. I can keep praying and trust His care.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, Answers to
- Prayer, How to
- Faith
- Suffering
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God’s companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I prayed for, and how long?
- ☐ What has God provided that I did not ask for?
- ☐ What do Paul and Jesus teach about unanswered prayer?
- ☐ How does the Spirit help me pray?
- ☐ What would trust look like if the answer is "not now" or "no"?
- ☐ Who can pray with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God hears the afflicted.
- ☐ The Spirit helps me pray.
- ☐ His grace is sufficient.
- ☐ His ways are higher.
- ☐ I can keep praying.
- ☐ Others can pray with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 22:24
  "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help."
- ☐ Romans 8:26
  "In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still praying: Each week, note one prayer and one provision.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 22:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God hears my cry for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Prayer, Answers to" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Keep a prayer journal. Note requests and unexpected blessings.
- [ ] Ask others to pray. Share with a friend.
- [ ] Pray honestly. Say what you feel.
- [ ] Read Romans 8:26. Rest in the Spirit's help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still praying
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have prayed and still hurt. Hear me, help me in my weakness, and give me trust to wait for Your answer. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.